

The next part is extremely important and doing it wrong might break the machine, so follow it carefully. You should be still within the Open dialog box. Change Files of type to All files. In the directory list above, scroll down and find `cmd.exe` and make a copy of that in the same folder (`cmd-copy`). Next, find `sethc` and rename it to `sethc1`, and then rename your `cmd-copy` to `sethc`. Close the Open dialog, then notepad and hit Finish to restart your machine.

Once you are back on the Windows login screen, press [Shift] five times to open up the command prompt. The next step is to find out the local administrator for your PC. Type `net localgroup Administrators` and typically look for an administrator name that does not have the domain related (school/workplace) name in front of it. This will probably be a random string of characters, as that is what most sys-admins tend to put up, to deter people trying to break in. Once you have identified such an account, time to change its password. Type `net user <ACCOUNT NAME HERE> *` hit [Enter] and type the new password twice (Don't worry if it doesn't show your keystrokes, it does still register them). One last thing to check before you can log into this account is if it has been kept active by the sys-admins. Type `net user <ACCOUNT NAME HERE> /active:yes`. This should activate the account, had it been inac-

tive, and now you can log in to the administrator account with the new password. It's a good idea to replace the new `sethc` file with the original one once you are done.

NETWORK FIREWALLS

One of the most common ways to get around a firewall is to use a proxy website. Of course this is common, so any decent sys-admin will have already blocked all commonly known proxies. Get Firefox installed (even if you have to get it via the sys-admin themselves). Start Firefox and go to Tools > Options > Connection Settings. You can find a list of available proxy IP addresses online as well.

A more reliable option would be to use UltraSurf or JonDo. Both use the self-invented GIFT system which is a high-encryption node-proxy anti-jamming system that allegedly has higher security standards than even financial transactions online. Both UltraSurf and JonDo are simple EXE files that connect automatically to a proxy server. They are portable software and can be run from a USB drive. Some systems have USB access restricted though.

You can also use remote access if you have a home PC on an unrestricted connection you can use that as your private proxy server to browse using its connection. Just go to Start > Accessories > Remote Desktop Connection. If your home computer

has a static IP address, put that in (if it does not, then sign it up with dyndns.org to associate a name to your computer). Once connected, you can use it like a virtual machine.

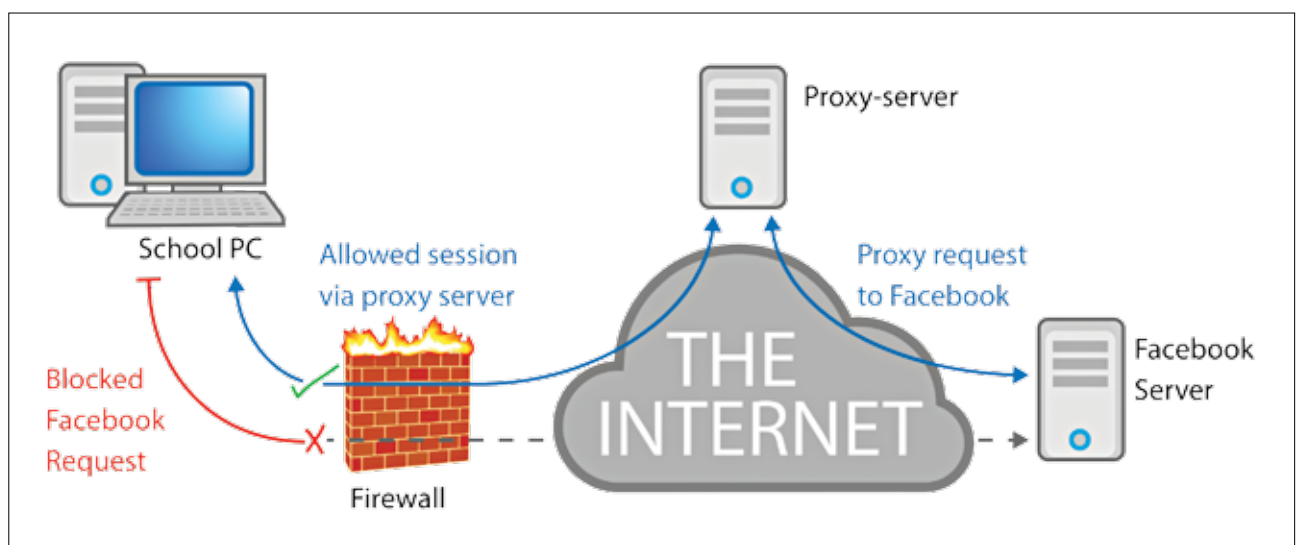
Using your phone's mobile data hotspot is another way of bypassing all internet restrictions. You could also use a VPN service to be able to browse freely, over an encrypted connection.

INSTALLATION ACCESS

If you are mainly reliant on a school or university computer for projects, research and more work, it can get particularly irritating when you want to use a free and legal tool that is essential for your project and you simply don't have access to do it. Even on a work PC, getting the admin department to install something for you each time you need it can be a real pain. Besides, what harm can VLC really do to a machine?

One of the simplest ways to get around this is to get portable versions of the applications that you need on a USB drive and run them on your target machine. Contrary to what you expect, portable versions are available for a large number of applications. Head over to <http://portableapps.com/apps> for a full list that contains all the categories and options that you will need.

Another method involves getting the installer file to extract into a folder. What this method does is, it simply



A rough representation of how a proxy server can help you bypass a network level filter